

A FEMININE CRUISE

Seventy miles from the shore of
Nicolas Island, the sixth of a
that cluster around the bay of
Barbara, California. It is called
for having been the residence for
een years of "The Lost Woman of
Nicolas." As her name is famous
her story has been told in romance
will give the bare facts about her
found them to be, without any
ornament and leave the fiction to
pen of the novelist.

The Island of San Nicolas is
densely populated. This is attested
the skulls and bones and other remains
of human habitation found there.
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the island to hunt for the furs of the
beaver. They took their women with
them and on returning after the hunt
over they left them on the island
to their fate. By order of the Governor
in 1835 the Indians were removed
from the island. Just before they
embarked and carry away every
inhabitant, as it was supposed,
an Indian woman begged for the
privilege of going ashore for her child, who
had accidentally left. She was
long time in a fruitless search for
her offspring. The wind blew a gale,
the water was shallow, there was a
man who was seeking the lost man. The
sail, intending to return for the
woman of San Nicolas, but as her
coming was unworthy, she was

coming unweariedly, she was
her fate. It was generally
there was a woman abandoned
island, but no attempt was made
deliverance. As the world went
so the lost woman of San Xico
forgotten, and the year passed.
After a lapse of sixteen years,
who landed on the island found
inhabited by someone. The
of a human being such deep
ground were seen. The hardest
ground was an indication that
been made a long time. The
size they evidently belonged to
Circular enclosures made of
or seven feet through, were seen,
some one lived. Near the
sticks driven into the ground

blubber hanging on them, they put
for food.

In 1842 San Nicolas was visited
and another hunt made for the long
woman. The dogs were very large
been seen before, but the old dog
had been taken away and one of the
the kind hung in its place. They
were found which ran away with
prowl of civilized man. In it
covered with seal skins that they
in a brush-heap, were a dress of
shag skins, a rope made of seal
several smaller articles, such as
hooks and bone needles. The discovery
of these proofs that there lived on
island a human being scattered on
the ground, and on their return
found them gathered together and
into the basket again.

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The Catholic fathers of the "Mission," the foremost in every pain and work, offered a reward to any who would find the lost woman. A third effort was made in 1853 when the prodigal about whom there was such a mystery and in whom the people of this coast was beginning to take interest. Fresh tracks of the woman were found. They belonged to small feet, and were like the ones seen in the first attempt to find the woman. Huts made of whalebone and covered with brush, were discovered. At length an object was seen at a distance that appeared to be moving towards it they saw the woman. For eighteen years had missed the

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lance that appeared to be moving
ing towards it they saw the woman
for eighteen years had reigned
San Nicolas, her subjects being
animals; her robe a dress of bird
she had made, and her throne
she had built. She was seated
closure, so that only her head and
dora could be seen. Two attendants
were about her that disappeared
command of their sovereign. He
seated on some grass that covered
ground and served her as a bed.
dress was nearly made of bird
tending to the ankles, the hem
which pointed downward. Her
was covered with a thick mat of
ish-brown hair and her shoulders
bare. She was occupied in the
shudder from a piece of white

she held across her knee, and for that purpose a knife made a deep loop. In her hat was a veil which she was talking to her occasionally shading her eyes and bald looked at the men who were searching of her. She received the much courtesy, bowing and showing that this lost child had much of the politeness of a woman. She took some refreshment and presented them to the men, and then to the men to eat. She put up all her front, which was in the best of order owing to the fashion she had experienced, washed her face, and cheerfully followed to the boat. On being taken to Barbara, she manifested great interest in the rights of civilization.

seeing the stigma of civilization
because a universal favorite
presented with many gifts. Her
on the Panama steamer the
there all wanted to see the lot
of San Nicolas. She related
her experiences on the trip
spoke a language none of them
knew, and none of the Spanish
except the Indian dialect could
stand. Civilization, which
the life of some, shortened the
wordian of San Nicolas. As the
love of fruit led her to dress
Barbara at the age of fifty. She
died with the honors of the
Church by the Franciscan order
has done and trickets were
taken and related to that part

Robert and placed in that net,
the world's darling.

The story of the lost woman
Nicolas will always remain a
mystery. Her ingenuity is un-
palleable made of grass, and
water by squeezing them with
her hands, and in her breast
her bone needles, her knife of bone,
and the language she invented for
it is inexplicable to all who have
her story told a woman could live
two years on an island where
the waves were beating a rock
loose, getting her food and
without even those facilities so
common to the savage. As a
woman would have perished
spontaneously in such a desolate
place, a philosopher's outlook.—
New York, Rochester Democrat.